

RIICC 2025 Student Charge

The company for the 2025 Russell Investments International Case Competition is the LEGO Group. Background is provided in this case:

"LEGO: Fostering Brand Love through Customer Communities,"
By Mohanbir Sawhney and Pallavi Goodman
Northwestern Kellogg School of Management KEI376
May 12, 2025

This case questions are about the intersection between LEGO and Artificial Intelligence. In 2025, researchers at Carnegie Mellon University released a free, open-source AI tool called BrickGPT (also sometimes called LegoGPT). The user describes an object in words and BrickGPT creates instructions for assembling the object from LEGO blocks. You will be considering what the LEGO company should do in response to BrickGPT. [Additional references are provided below].

Roles: You are an AI strategy team in the LEGO Group. The judges are senior executives at LEGO.

Questions:

1. Should the LEGO company incorporate AI in the form of BrickGPT (or something similar) in its products? If so, how? If not, why not?

What are the benefits? What are the risks?

What are the implications of your answer for LEGO marketing? For the LEGO Ideas competition?
2. How does your recommendation reflect
 - (a) the lessons that LEGO took from its experience since 2003?
 - (b) the values of the LEGO Group?
3. How is AI like BrickGPT likely to affect LEGO's revenues and costs over the next 3 years [note: do not consider AI applied to sourcing or manufacturing]?

References:

Descriptions of BrickGPT can be found in

Marylee Williams, "Imagination Meets Automation With BrickGPT," Carnegie Mellon University, July 24, 2025, <https://www.cs.cmu.edu/news/2025/brick-gpt> , and <https://www.instagram.com/reel/DJkZfu7TP2-/?hl=en>

For more technical details (optional), see, for example:

<https://avalovelace1.github.io/BrickGPT/> , and

"Prompt-to-Product: Generative Assembly via Bimanual Manipulation with Legos," AI Papers Podcast Daily, August 31, 2025, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YIIPbD8KOnk>